The Big Dogs Ryder Cup

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BDT 2004 · Lagos · Featuring Hursty & Boggy

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

Where to end 101 Tour Memories? Gut instinct says that there can be no better place than by going right back to where it all began – nearly – with the advent of the Big Dogs Ryder Cup.



The Big Dogs Ryder Cup!

Although the first two tours were tremendous occasions and realised the beginnings of the Green Jacket, undoubtedly it was on the Lagos trip of BDT 2004 that the tour really stepped up a notch with the introduction of the Big Dogs Ryder Cup.

This was the brainchild of Boggy and Hursty, but how were the first ever Retriever and Bloodhound teams selected? Were they drawn out of a hat, completely random or was there a mechanical method to it?

Having investigated with Boggy and Hursty, the answer is a mixture of all three, consisting of two Dogs selected for each team out of three Pools based on golfing ability:

Pool A: Marshy, Boggy, Hursty & Ash
Pool B: Ravo, Robbo, Picko & Buzz
Pool C: Paddy, Charlie, Langrish & Knoxy

The first ever teams selected on tour were:

BLOODHOUNDS	RETRIEVERS
Boggy (c)	Hursty (c)
Ash	Marshy
Ravo	Robbo
Buzz	Picko
Charlie	Paddy
Langrish	Knoxy

Back then who would have thought that all these Dogs would still represent the teams they first started on 22 Ryder Cups earlier?!

Boysie, BT & Little also came on the 2004 Lagos tour but as short tourists who did not compete in the Ryder Cup, a decision that we know they regret to this day!

Knoxy was our tour Phodographer in Lagos and he took tons of snaps but sadly his laptop was stolen and with it went virtually all the tour photos from that year, so we have no visual record of the beginnings of the Ryder Cup. Recollections are that on the first evening the Trophy and teams were unveiled by Boggy and Hursty, as the first tour Captains, over a beer or two.

We do have a gallery of subsequent Ryder Cup handover moments from most of the tours that have followed and I have added this below.

Remarkably after 22 Ryder Cup competitions we head to Scottsdale for the latest leg of the journey along the long and winding BDT road all square with 11 victories apiece; the script could not have been written any more perfectly.

Long may our journey continue over the years to come and we wish our two Captains, Ash and Robbo, the very best of luck in leading their troops into action.

May the best Dogs bring home from the USA the 23rd Ryder Cup after our 25th adventure!

RYDER CUP MOMENTS OVER THE YEARS!



BDT 2005: Vilamoura



BDT 2006: Mallorca



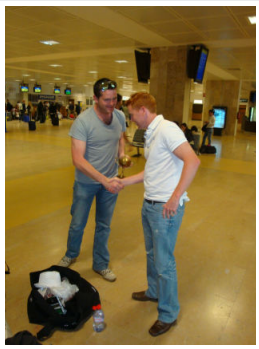
BDT 2007: Dubai



BDT 2008: Lisbon



BDT 2009: Vale do Lobes



BDT 2010: Girona



BDT 2011: Miami



BDT 2012: Marbella



BDT 2013: Marbella



BDT 2017: Mallorca



BDT 2018: Valencia



BDT 2019: Cyprus



BDT 2020: The Belfry



BDT 2021: Celtic Manor



BDT 2023: Turkey



BDT 2024: Turkey



BDT 2025: Marrakech

SINCE SCOTTSDALE

The Retrievers won the 23rd Big Dogs Ryder Cup 12.5–11.5 in Scottsdale, so after 23 contests the Retrievers lead 12–11.





BDT 2026: Ash Hands Robbo The Big Dogs Ryder Cup